

InNews is a Cable TV News channel which is popular for its Regional News played out in Kannada & Marathi in Belagavi and its surrounding districts. The TV channel earns its revenue based on sales of airtime for Advertising spots (15 seconds, 30 seconds and L-band, Aston bands) played in the middle or in-between breaks of the live news telecast. These advertisements are received from clients in various forms, for example a release order (format attached here as RO_sample.docx) or a simple WhatsApp message confirmation. The main components of an RO are the Start date, Stop date for the Ad, Frequency of playout, Spot offered (prime time live telecast, repeat telecast etc.), bonuses offered, media. The price per spot is negotiated with the management and may sometimes include the cost of designing the media or airing the client provided media itself.

They currently do not have a well defined process or tool to handle login these ROs, or handle multiple ROs and hence challenges occur, like:

1. Missed start date
2. Missed to stop the media after it has started airing
3. Incorrect frequency of Ad runs (thus resulting in extra or under airing)
4. Preparing & submitting an official Playout report on-time
5. Generating of an invoice & emailing to the client along with the Playout report
6. Sending auto reminders to clients to release the payment
7. Squaring off received payments with the RO and Invoice, so it is easier to submit to the Accounts during tax season.

The current RO format is as below:

Client details	Scroll	Kannada	Marathi	Publish From:	To:
RO date:	Repeat times				
RO #	Audio/Video	Kannada	Marathi	Publish From:	To:
Name:	Repeat times				
Address:	Balance	Paid	Amount		
Ph#			GST		
GST#			Total		

The receiving of a RO (release order) is the trigger for an Ads playout workflow which ensues the following steps:

1. Log in the RO into this ROMS (Release Order Management System). This is done via the Sales Executive / Operations Associate profile
2. Attach the media to the RO entry so that it can be validated for run readiness. Management profile is notified for approval
3. If denied, then Sales Executive / Operations Associate is notified, who in-turn uploads/corrects any short-comings in the RO data and media
4. Once approved, the Playout chart is updated with the RO details and is submitted to the On-air Media Coordinator.
5. The On-air Media Coordinator's role is to ensure that the media is scheduled as per the frequency, start and stop dates in the RO. A dashboard interface highlights all the media

that is being currently played, upcoming playout requests, soon-to-expire reminders and any other exceptions (intermittent stop, disruption in playouts etc.,).

6. Their daily workflow starts on the dashboard with clearing up notifications of Ads that have to be turned off. Such a step requires updating the line item with a screenshot (that the Ad has been stopped), generating a Playout report (which sends it back to the Operations Associate to generate the Invoice)
7. In case there is a media error or early termination of contract, the On-air Media Coordinator will need communication to stop the same
8. Evidence of media started / stopped on the appropriate days
9. In case when the On-air Media Coordinator is absent, no action on their pending tasks should alert the management
10. In case of the Operations Associate not having generated the Invoice even after 24 hours of having generated the Play-out report, alert the management

The implementation of the ROMS (Release Order Management System) should help:

1. Avoid miscommunication between the sales, Operations Associate, On-air Media Coordinator and the Accounts team
2. Allow the management to view / approve / reject on a specific RO
3. Give the management a view of all the presently scheduled & running media Ads on a dashboard
4. The Operations Associate role will have the capability to:
 - a. Create a client record to maintain all the ROs, invoices, playout reports under that
 - b. Mark who/which agency or freelancer was responsible in submitting this RO
 - c. Attribute the invoice to the above person and internally calculate the commission structure for that individual / agency
 - d. add/edit ROs and seek for approval from management
 - e. Dashboard displaying all the approved / rejected ROs, Playout reports received from On-air Media Coordinator
 - f. Revise & edit the start date, end date if the RO is revised by the client or the agency co-ordinator
 - g. Separate section that will allow generating of invoices based on RO & Playout report, email a pdf copy to the client after it has been approved by the management
 - h. Aging of these invoices until payment is received in full. These will be added to "Payment follow-ups" section of the dashboard that will be at the top of this role's dashboard
 - i. Marking invoice "Partially paid", "Fully paid" and the mode of payment (UPI, cheque, bank UTR, Cash) and details of the payment method
 - j. Invoices aging above 14 days will be marked yellow and ones which remain unpaid for 30 days will be marked red and moved to the top of the list
 - k. print/email/download invoices, playout reports & ROs
 - l. Sort invoices, playout reports & ROs - client wise and month wise
 - m. Print summary report for all the ROs submitted, invoices generated and the status of the payment collection
 - n. Reminders will be sent as per programmed repeat frequency.
 - o. Received payments have to be updated manually.
5. The On-air Media Coordinator's dashboard will have the ability to:
 - a. View the assigned ROs
 - b. update/stop/start the ROs added into the system.
 - c. Provide full visibility on all the scheduled/running/close to completion ROs in the playout system

- d. In case of revisions on the RO, highlight the revision prominently on the dashboard.
 - e. Once the revision is affected, a log entry to register the exact time & date when the revision was put into effect
 - f. Generate a playout report that gets posted to the Operations Associate's dashboard for Invoice preparation
 - g. Update the playout report if a certain RO media was played in short / extra due to a specific reason (update the reason in text)
6. The invoice generation will use the following format
(https://docs.google.com/document/d/1GE53_Rwzbzfk-9sv8RbHGnk7d1wO-qgD/edit?usp=sharing&ouid=117889196633347303074&rtpof=true&sd=true) and the following workflow rules will apply
- a. Option to calculate and include/exclude GST in the invoice will be controlled by a checkbox
 - b. All <fill> items are be input by the operator
 - c. Invoice number format IN/2025-26/<increment> will increment and the 2025-26 will replace at the beginning of the financial year (April 1st)
 - d. Client name & GST number will be taken from the RO
 - e. The "Ref:" is taken from the RO (if client has provided), or the internal system generated RO number